

72nd BPSC PRELIMS

प्रहार

Test Series

Test- 01

Bihar Special

Solution

English



Khan Global Studies

Most Trusted Learning Platform

BPSC TEST-1 (SOLUTION)

Q 1. Ans. B

Explanation:

- The Harha Valley is located in the West Champaran district, forming part of the northernmost physiographic region of Bihar.
- It lies within the Shivalik system, between the Someshwar Range and Ramnagar Doon.
- It gets its name from the Harha River, which is a left bank tributary of the Burhi Gandak River.

Q 2. Ans. B

Explanation:

- The Jamui region forms part of the Jharkhand-Bihar Mica Belt, which is a high-quality ruby mica zone extending through Chakai, Batia, and Charka Pathar.
- These deposits occur in pegmatite rocks of the Chotanagpur Plateau, and areas like Chakai block, Batia, and Charka Pathar are well-known for producing high-quality mica, forming part of a larger belt extending into Nawada.

Q 3. Ans. B

Explanation:

- As of September 2025, Bihar has a total of 6389 km of the National Highways network, distributed across 57 National Highways.
- This reflects Bihar's 4.2% share in India's total National Highways network, contributing to regional connectivity.

Q 4. Ans. D

Explanation:

- A total of 29 women were elected to the 18th Bihar Legislative Assembly in 2025. This represents an increase from the 2020 elections, which had 26 women elected.
- Overall representation: Women make up 12% of the newly elected 18th Assembly. This is an increase from 2020, when women constituted 10.7% of the MLAs.
- Of the 29 women elected in 2025, 13 are between the ages of 25 and 39, while 9 are between the ages of 40 and 54.
- Approximately half of the women elected to the 18th Assembly (15 MLAs) do not have college degrees.

Q 5. Ans. A

Explanation:

- **Pair 1 is Correct:** Dharwar Rocks are among the oldest rock systems in Bihar (Precambrian) and are found in the south-eastern region (Jamui, Nawada, Munger, and Banka). They are highly metamorphosed and form the famous "Mica Belt" of Bihar, making them the richest source of minerals in the state.

- **Pair 2 is Incorrect:** Vindhyan Rocks are not newly formed, nor are they in the Gangetic plains. They are ancient sedimentary rocks found in the south-western districts (Rohtas and Kaimur). They are famous precisely because they do have minerals, specifically non-metallic minerals like limestone, dolomite, and pyrite.
- **Pair 3 is Correct:** Tertiary Rocks are found exclusively in the north-western tip of Bihar (West Champaran), forming the Someshwar Hills and the Ramnagar Dun. Because they were formed relatively recently during the Himalayan uplift, they lack significant economic mineral deposits.
- **Pair 4 is Incorrect:** Quaternary Rocks are the newly formed alluvial soils of the Gangetic plains (built by the Ganga and its tributaries). They are excellent for agriculture, but are not used for building materials like limestone.

Q 6. Ans. C

Explanation:

- According to the Census 2011, the exact population densities (persons per sq. km) for the districts given in the options are:
 - ✓ Darbhanga: 1,728
 - ✓ Sitamarhi: 1,492
 - ✓ Samastipur: 1,467
 - ✓ Madhubani: 1,282
- Highest Density Districts:
 - ✓ Sheohar: 1,880
 - ✓ Patna: 1,823
 - ✓ Darbhanga: 1,728
- Lowest Density Districts:
 - ✓ Kaimur (Bhabua): 488
 - ✓ Jamui: 568
 - ✓ Banka: 674

Q 7. Ans. B

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** Mokama Tal is known as the "pulse bowl of Bihar", as it is a major centre for pulse cultivation, especially masur (lentil). It is not a single tal; instead, it is a group of 7 tals.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** Mokama Taal extends across the districts of Patna, Begusarai, and Samastipur, with some parts also reported in Nalanda, Sheikhpura and Lakhisarai. It is a saucer-shaped depression along the right bank of the Ganga River.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** The region is one of the major producers of masur (lentil) in India and also produces gram, peas, and other pulses in large quantities, supported by its seasonal water retention

and fertile alluvial soil conditions. Marcha Rice of West Champaran is an indigenous paddy variety renowned for its unique aroma and high-quality rice flakes.

Q 8. Ans. B

Explanation:

- The Kharagpur Hills are composed of Dharwar (Precambrian) rocks, which are rich in minerals such as bauxite, mica, iron ore, and slate.
- Bauxite is one of the characteristic minerals of this region, whereas minerals like pyrite and coal are associated with different geological formations.

Q 9. Ans. B

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** The Chatra Canal system is located in Nepal, not in the Supaul district; it is associated with the proposed Sapta Koshi High Dam project near Chatra in Nepal, which is separate from the existing Kosi Barrage at Bhimnagar. It is designed to provide irrigation to large areas in Nepal and Bihar after the Sapta Koshi project is constructed.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The Eastern Kosi Canal system originates from the Kosi Barrage, has a main canal length of about 43.47 km, and includes five branch canals-Murliganj, Jankinagar, Purnea, Araria, and Rajpura, irrigating about 6.12 lakh hectares across seven districts of Bihar.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** The Western Kosi Canal was included in the Third Five-Year Plan (1961–1966), and its alignment was approved by the Government of Nepal in 1961; although it also originates from the Kosi Barrage, it is treated as a separate irrigation project within the Kosi basin system.

Q 10. Ans. B

Explanation:

- Katihar Division is part of the Northeast Frontier Railway (NFR) zone, which manages rail operations in the North-Eastern region of India.
- Due to its strategic location, Katihar Division handles significant rail traffic and ensures connectivity between Bihar and the North-East, making it operationally important.
- Railway zones covering Bihar:
 - ✓ East Central Railway (ECR)
 - ✓ Eastern Railway (ER)
 - ✓ Northeast Frontier Railway (NFR)
 - ✓ North Eastern Railway (NER)

Q 11. Ans. C

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The scheme provides financial assistance including an initial grant of ₹10,000 and based on the successful initiation and progress of their business, they become eligible for further phased financial assistance scaling up to a maximum of ₹2 lakh.

- **Statement 2 is correct:** It is implemented through JEEViKA in rural areas and with support from the Urban Development and Housing Department in urban areas, ensuring wide institutional coverage and effective execution.

Q 12. Ans. B

Explanation:

- The Saat Nischay 3.0 programme has been launched for the period 2025–2030, focusing on achieving growth with justice and comprehensive development.
- It aims to enhance employment, infrastructure, industrial growth, agriculture, education, and healthcare in Bihar.

Q 13. Ans. C

Explanation:

- Bihar secured a return to the Ranji Trophy Elite Group by defeating Manipur by 568 runs in the Plate final.
- The win was driven by Piyush Singh's double century and strong bowling performances from Suraj Kashyap and Himanshu Singh, marking a significant comeback after their earlier relegation from the Elite division.

Q 14. Ans. D

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The Bihar Semiconductor Policy 2026 aims to increase the semiconductor sector's contribution to 5% of the state economy within five years, reflecting a strategic push towards high-tech industrialisation.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The policy sets a clear investment target of ₹25,000 crore, indicating the state's intent to attract large-scale investments in semiconductor, display, and chip design industries.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** It offers an additional 20% subsidy over central incentives, which enhances investment attractiveness and competitiveness, while supporting the establishment of fabs and ATMP units under a structured policy framework.

Q 15. 15. Ans. C

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** At the Wings India 2026 summit held in Hyderabad (January 2026), Bihar was conferred the national award for being the 'Most Proactive State' under the RCS-UDAN (Regional Connectivity Scheme). This was in recognition of the state's rapid progress in land acquisition for airports (like Purnea and Darbhanga) and administrative reforms.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** A major factor behind Bihar's top ranking was the state's aggressive fiscal policy. The Bihar government slashed the VAT on Aviation Turbine Fuel (ATF) from 29% to 4% at all its airports
- **Additional facts:**
 - ✓ The Bihar Flying School (Patna) was also

highlighted during the event for achieving the 2nd rank nationally in the latest Directorate General of Civil Aviation (DGCA) evaluation.

- ✓ Aviation Turbine Fuel (ATF) is a high-quality kerosene-type distillate with a very low freezing point (-47°C) for high-altitude flight and remains outside the GST net.

Q 16. Ans. B

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The third edition of Unmesha, Asia's largest international literature festival, was held in Patna, Bihar, from September 25 to 28, 2025. It was a joint collaboration between the Sahitya Akademi, the Ministry of Culture (GoI), and the Government of Bihar.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** While they were announced at the same press conference, "Unmesha" and "Gyan Bharatam" are two completely distinct initiatives. Unmesha is a literature festival. In contrast, "Gyan Bharatam" is a specific Ministry of Culture mission dedicated to the survey, documentation, digitisation, and conservation of India's extensive manuscript heritage.

Q 17. Ans. D

Explanation:

- Aarti Gupta, a resident of Bihar Sharif, the Nalanda district headquarters in Bihar, has become the first woman from the state to visit Antarctica, the world's coldest place.
- Aarti, sent by the Patna branch of the India Meteorological Department, is part of the 45th Indian Scientists' Antarctica Winter Expedition.

Q 18. Ans. A

Explanation:

- The India Post has recently established Bihar's first Gen-Z Post Office at IIT Patna campus in Bihta, with the objective of transforming traditional postal services into modern, youth-centric, and digitally enabled service hubs designed to cater to students and the needs of Generation Z.

Q 19. Ans. D

Explanation:

- The Bihar government has approved the Kaimur Wildlife Sanctuary as the state's second tiger reserve, after the Valmiki Tiger Reserve (VTR) in West Champaran district. Kaimur Wildlife Sanctuary is located in two different districts named Kaimur and Rohtas districts. The sanctuary has ancient cave paintings and the oldest Fossil Park to its acclaim.
- The forests of Kaimur, spanning approximately 1,134 square kilometres, constitute the largest forested area in Bihar and record the highest green cover in the state, at

about 34 percent. These forests also form an integral part of a broader ecological network, linking with adjoining wildlife corridors across the neighbouring states of Jharkhand, Uttar Pradesh, and Madhya Pradesh.

- In the sanctuary area, we can see Black Buck, Chinkara, Sambhar, Cheetal, Bear, Leopard, Wolf & Blue Bull etc.
- In flora Bamboo, Palas, Khair, Mahua, Dhau etc.

Q 20. Ans. A

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The Bihar Government, under the Department of Education, launched the Mukhyamantri Bharat Darshan Yojana for students of state-run secondary schools. It aims to promote cultural awareness, national integration, and experiential learning.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** The scheme is strictly limited to students enrolled in government and state-run secondary schools. It does not extend to students from private schools. This initiative is a 100% state-funded program designed specifically to provide exposure and act as an incentive for high-performing students within the public education system.

Q 21. Ans. C

Explanation:

- UltraTech Cement Ltd is establishing a major cement grinding unit in Banka district of Bihar with an investment of around ₹1,200–1,344 crore.
- This project aims to enhance industrial capacity, regional infrastructure, and economic growth, while strengthening Bihar's position in the cement and construction sector.

Q 22. Ans. B

Explanation:

- Vaibhav Suryavanshi, a young cricketer from Bihar, was awarded the Pradhan Mantri Rashtriya Bal Puraskar 2025, the country's highest civilian honour for achievers below 18 years.
- He earned recognition for becoming the youngest IPL player and fastest Indian centurion in the league.
- He hails from Tajpur village in the Samastipur district.

Q 23. Ans. B

Explanation:

- The Dr. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam Science City is located in Patna district, specifically at Rajendra Nagar, and was inaugurated as a major centre for science and innovation.
- Spread over 21 acres, it features five galleries, 269 science exhibits, a 4D theatre, and an auditorium, and has been developed at a cost of ₹889 crore over five years, making it a significant addition to Bihar's scientific infrastructure.

Q 24. Ans. C**Explanation:**

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Bihar becomes 1st state to adopt the e-voting system for urban polls using an Android-based mobile. This initiative will help migrant labourers, migrant voters, divyang voters, pregnant female voters, elderly and senior citizens, and seriously ill electorates will be able to cast their votes using the e-voting process.
 - ✓ The legal backing for this was provided by amending the Bihar Municipal Act, 2007.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The entire e-voting process will be executed through two mobile apps, namely “e-Voting SECBHR”, one developed by the Centre for Development of Advanced Computing (C-DAC) and another by the Bihar State Election Commission.
 - ✓ To ensure a tamper-proof election, the system utilises a Blockchain platform, live facial scanning (FRS) with liveness detection, and generates a digital audit trail akin to an EVM’s VVPAT.
- Note: Gujarat was the first state to introduce e-voting overall in 2010 via web browsers/kiosks, but Bihar is the first to execute it via a dedicated smartphone app

Q 25. Ans. B**Explanation:**

- Five districts of Bihar—East Champaran, Purnia, Patna, Samastipur, and Madhubani—along with three senior officials, including Vinod Singh Gunjyal, the Chief Electoral Officer (CEO) of Bihar, were honoured with national awards for their outstanding performance in various aspects of the Assembly Election 2025.
- Patna Innovation in voter awareness programs
- East Champaran Adoption of better technology for the election processes
- Purnea Better election management performance
- Samastipur Effective implementation of the Model Code of Conduct
- Madhubani Excellence in training and capacity building

Q 26. Ans. C**Explanation:**

- Vasupujya, the 12th Jain Tirthankara, was born at Champapuri (Bhagalpur) in Bihar, which is an important Jain pilgrimage site.
- His symbol is the buffalo, and his father was King Vasupujya, while his mother was Vijaya (also called Jaya), as per Jain traditions.

Additional facts about Champapuri:

- Only place where all 5 Kalyanas of Tirthankar Vasupujya occurred:
 - ✓ Garbha, Janma, Diksha, Kevalajnana, Moksha.

● Monsoon stays:
✓ Adinatha, Parshvanatha, and Mahavira stayed here;
✓ Mahavira: 3rd & 12th Chaturmas at Champauri.
● Status: Siddhakṣetra (place of salvation).
● Ascetics attaining salvation:
✓ Dharmaghosh, Padmarath, Ashok, and Anchal.
● Important feature:
✓ Ancient Champanala temple is present.

Q 27. Ans. A**Explanation:**

- Bhukti: It was the largest provincial unit under the Guptas, administered by an Uparika, covering large territories such as Tirabhukti, Srinagarabhukti, and Magadhabhukti in Bihar.
- Vishaya: A sub-division of Bhukti (district level) governed by a Vishayapati or Kumaramatya, assisted by officials like Nagarasrestha, Sarthavaha, Kulika, and Prathama Kayastha.
- Mahattara: The village elder, responsible for administering the lowest unit of governance (village level). Consent of Mahattaras was needed for land sale.
- Agraharika: An officer in charge of Agrahara villages, which were tax-free land grants given to Brahmanas, ensuring their supervision and administration.

Other Key officials:

● Saulkika	Customs officer
● Dandapanka	Police officer
● Vinayasthitisthapaka	Judicial officer
● Mahapratihara	Palace guard head
● Gulmika	Minor military officer

Q 28. Ans. B**Explanation:**

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** Sujata Stupa is located at Bakraur near Bodh Gaya and is associated with Sujata, the milkmaid who ended Buddha’s prolonged fast by offering milk and rice, marking a key event before his enlightenment.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The stupa was originally built in the 2nd century BCE, and excavations by the Archaeological Survey of India (1973–74 and 2001–06) revealed an 8th–9th century CE inscription of King Devapala of the Pala dynasty, indicating later reconstruction and expansion; it also originally had an Ashokan pillar later shifted to Bodh Gaya in 1956.

Q 29. Ans. B**Explanation:**

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The Buddhist text Anguttara Nikaya and the Jain text Bhagavati Sutra are the

primary literary sources that explicitly list the 16 Mahajanapadas.

- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** The Vajji confederacy was known for the Licchavi republic, but its capital was Vaishali, not Champa. Champa was the capital of the Anga Mahajanapada.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** Magadha was the most powerful Mahajanapada. Its initial capital was Rajgriha (also known as Girivraja), heavily fortified by five hills, before it was later shifted to Pataliputra by Udayin.
- Additional information:
 - ✓ **1. Anga Mahajanapada (Eastern Bihar)**
 - Modern Location: Bhagalpur and Munger districts.
 - Capital: Champa (Ancient name: Malini).
 - Key Fact: The architect of Champa city was Mahagovind. Anga was eventually annexed into Magadha by Bimbisara after he defeated its ruler, Brahmadatta.
 - ✓ **2. Vajji/Vriji Mahajanapada (Northern Bihar)**
 - Modern Location: Vaishali and Muzaffarpur region (North of the Ganga).
 - Capital: Vaishali.
 - Political Structure: It was not a monarchy; it was the world's first republic (Ganarajya). It was a confederacy of 8 clans (Ashtakula), the most dominant being the Licchavis, Videhans, and Jnatikas (Lord Mahavira belonged to the Jnatika clan).
 - ✓ **3. Magadha Mahajanapada (Southern Bihar)**
 - Modern Location: Patna, Gaya, and Nalanda districts.
 - Capital: Rajgriha/Girivraja (Initial) - Pataliputra (Later) - Vaishali (Briefly under Shishunaga) - Pataliputra.
 - Key Fact: Guarded by the Ganga and Son rivers (Jaldurga) and the hills of Rajgir, it had a massive geographic and economic advantage (iron ore access) that allowed it to conquer all others.

Q 30. Ans. D

Explanation:

- Amitraghata is Bindusara's most famous Sanskrit title, meaning "Slayer of Foes" (mentioned in Patanjali's Mahabhashya).
- Amitraketas (or Amitrochates/Allitrochades) is simply the Greek transliteration of the title Amitraghata, used by ancient Greek historians like Strabo and Athenaeus.
- Singhsen (Simhasena) was actually his original birth name, according to Jain texts like the Rajavali-Katha.
- Amitrari is a Sanskrit word meaning "enemy of enemies", but it was not the title of Bindusara.
- Additional information:
 - ✓ Puranic Texts: The Vayu Purana calls him Bhadrāsara, while the Bhagavata Purana refers to him as Varisara.

- ✓ Chinese Texts: The traveller Fa-Hien recorded his name as Vindusara.
- ✓ Diplomatic Title: Long before Ashoka made it famous, Bindusara was also occasionally addressed by the title Devanampriya ("Beloved of the Gods").
- ✓ Deimachus: Sent by the Syrian King Antiochus I to Bindusara's court at Pataliputra. (Note: Megasthenes came to his father, Chandragupta's court).
- ✓ Dionysius: Sent by Ptolemy II Philadelphus of Egypt. (debated whether he arrived at the very end of Bindusara's reign or early in Ashoka's).
- ✓ Bindusara maintained strong diplomatic ties with the Hellenistic world. He famously wrote a letter to Antiochus I of Syria requesting three things: Sweet wine, dried figs, and a Greek sophist (philosopher). Antiochus sent the wine and figs but politely declined the third, stating that Greek law forbade the sale of a philosopher.

Q 31. Ans. A

Explanation:

- Bakhtiyar Khilji destroyed the Odantapuri University in 1193 AD during his early military raids against the Sena kingdom in Bihar.
- After its destruction, he constructed a fort at the site (Bihar Sharif) to consolidate his control and mark his victory.

Q 32. Ans. D

Explanation:

- ✓ **Statement A is correct:** Maner Sharif developed into a centre of learning during the Mughal period, where Islamic scholarship coexisted with elements of Sanskrit intellectual traditions, including references to Panini.
- ✓ **Statement B is correct:** The complex includes Bari Dargah (tomb of Hazrat Makhdum Yahya Maneri) and Choti Dargah (tomb of Makhdum Shah Daulat), both important religious and architectural monuments.
- **Statement C is correct:** Chhoti Dargah features a large dome, Quranic inscriptions, and refined stone carving; built in the 17th century during the rule of Shah Jahan, it reflects mature Mughal architecture with symmetry, sandstone use, and calligraphy.
- **Statement D is incorrect:** Both Bari Dargah and Chhoti Dargah were not constructed during the reign of Sher Shah Suri. Chhoti Dargah was built in the Mughal period by Ibrahim Khan Kakar, a governor under Shah Jahan, while Bari Dargah predates this phase and is not associated with Sher Shah's patronage.

Q 33. Ans. B

Explanation:

- ✓ **Statement 1 is incorrect:** Lota Rebellion (1856 AD)

was organised by the prisoners of the Muzaffarpur Jail a year before the revolution of 1857. This rebellion was led by the inmates, most of whom were poor farmers.

- ✓ **Statement 2 is correct:** The government's decision to replace brass (lota) pots with clay ones was the cause of the rebellion; the prisoners revolted against this degradation, not because they used the brass pot as a physical weapon. The brass pot was a symbol and trigger of the revolt, not a weapon used in battle.

Q 34. Ans. D

Explanation:

- Bihar Herald : Guru Prasad Sen
- Desher Katha : Sakham Ganesh Deuskar
- Searchlight : Sachidanand Sinha
- Motherland : Mazharul Haque

Q 35. Ans. A

Explanation:

- Babu Amar Singh the zamindar of Jagdishpur, was a revolutionary in the Indian Rebellion of 1857. After subsequent guerrilla skirmishes with the British, Amar Singh fled with other rebel leaders to the Nepal Terai in October 1859.
- However, in mid-December 1859, he was captured by forces under Maharaja Jung Bahadur of Nepal, who was cooperating with the British. He was subsequently imprisoned in Gorakhpur Jail, where he died of dysentery on February 5, 1860, before any trial could take place. Amar Singh was also a deeply religious person and had the Mahabharata recited to him every night.

Q 36. Ans. D

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Prabhavati Devi was an Indian political dissident. She established the Mahila Charkha Samiti at Patna to include abandoned and deserted ladies in the charkha or the turning wheel development on the Gandhian model. When the Quit India Movement began, she was captured and shipped off to Bhagalpur prison.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** Tara Rani was born into a straightforward family in Saran, Bihar, and got married to Phulendu Babu. She joined the Quit India Movement of Gandhi Ji in 1942, controlled dissents, and intended to raise the Indian banner on the top of the Siwan Police Station.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** Vindhyavasini Devi, alongside different women, was captured during the salt unrest in 1930. She was shipped off to Muzaffarpur prison in 1932, and the public authority pronounced the Kanya Swyam Sevika Dal unlawful.

Q 37. Ans. D

Explanation:

- The secret radio station operated by activists during the Quit India Movement in 1942 was Congress Radio (Azad Radio), run by Usha Mehta and her associates. It was based in Bombay (now Mumbai). The movement was launched on August 8, 1942, with Mahatma Gandhi's famous speech in Bombay's Gowalia Tank maidan: "Do or die."

Q 38. Ans. D

Explanation:

- Parti Parikatha by Phanishwar Nath Renu presents a multi-layered portrayal of a region and its people, shaped by the Kosi River and history. The novel is set in and around Paranjpur and the Kosi plains, where the once fertile land is left choked with silt after the river's sudden change of course.
- Panchlight, a story written by Phanishwar Nath 'Renu', depicts a rural village without electricity, where the arrival of a kerosene lamp symbolises hope and change. The story centres on Godhan, who, despite being ostracised, helps light the Panchlight and unites the community, highlighting themes of superstition, simplicity, and the encounter with modernity.
- Van Tulasi ki Gandh is a well-known short story collection by Phanishwar Nath Renu. It reflects rural life, emotions, and the fragrance of village culture in Bihar through simple yet deeply expressive storytelling.
- Chandrakanta is not written by Phanishwar Nath Renu. It is a famous Hindi fantasy novel written by Devaki Nandan Khatri, known for its adventure and supernatural elements, which is completely different from Renu's regional realist writing style.

Q 39. Ans. A

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** After the decline of the Pala dynasty, the Sena dynasty was established under the leadership of Samanta Sena.
✓ Vijaya Sena was the most powerful ruler of this dynasty and defeated Nanyadeva, the ruler of the Karnata dynasty.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** Jayadeva, the 12th-century poet and author of Gita Govinda, was associated with the court of Lakshmana Sena, highlighting the literary and cultural prominence of the Sena dynasty.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** When Nadia fell to Bakhtiyar Khilji's invasion in 1204, Lakshmana Sena fled not to Bishnupur but to eastern Bengal (likely Vikrampur), where the Sena dynasty continued to rule under him and his successors for some time thereafter.

Q 40. Ans. D

Explanation:

- Ripunjaya was the last ruler of the Brihadratha dynasty,

marking the end of this early Magadhan lineage.

- He was killed by his minister Pulika (Punika), who placed his own son Pradyota on the throne, establishing the Pradyota dynasty as the successor to the Brihadrathas in Magadha.
- Important rulers:
 - ✓ Brihadratha: Founder of the dynasty and the Magadha empire.
 - ✓ Jarasandha: Most powerful ruler; vastly expanded Magadhan territory.
 - ✓ Sahadeva: Jarasandha's son; ruled during and died in the Kurukshetra War.

Q 41. Ans. C

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** During the Khalji dynasty, Alauddin Khalji aggressively expanded towards the east. He dispatched his commander, Sheikh Mohammad Ismail, to invade the Tirhut region (modern-day Darbhanga/Mithila). However, he was militarily defeated by the Karnata dynasty ruler, Sakra Singh (Saktisimhadeva). Recognising Sakra Singh's strength, Alauddin Khalji eventually formed a diplomatic alliance with him rather than subjugating the territory completely.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** During the Tughlaq dynasty, the administrative centre of the Bihar province was officially established at Bihar Sharif (formerly Odantapuri). It became the political and cultural heart of medieval Bihar, heavily influenced by the presence of prominent Sufi saints like Hazrat Makhdum Sharfuddin Yahya Maneri.
- **Additional Information:**
 - ✓ Mamluk (Slave) Dynasty
 - Ilutmish was the first Delhi Sultan to organise a military campaign and bring Bihar under the Delhi Sultanate. (1225 CE).
 - After defeating Hisamuddin Iwaz Khalji, he appointed Malik Alauddin Jani as the first Governor of Bihar.
 - ✓ Fall of the Karnata Dynasty
 - Alauddin Khalji failed, but Ghiyasuddin Tughlaq succeeded in conquering Tirhut (1324 CE) during his return from the Bengal campaign.
 - Harisimhadeva, the last major Karnata ruler, was defeated and fled to Nepal, ending Karnata rule in Mithila.
 - ✓ Tughlaq Administration in Bihar
 - Tughlaqs brought Tirhut under direct central administration.
 - Muhammad Bin Tughlaq minted coins in Tirhut and temporarily renamed Darbhanga as Tughlaqpur.
 - Firuz Shah Tughlaq's rule is evidenced by inscriptions in the Bihar Sharif Jama Masjid and Jain temples of Rajgir.

Q 42. Ans. A

Explanation:

- Bahar Khan Nuhani (son of Dariya Khan Nuhani) declared independence in Bihar, assumed the title Sultan Muhammad, and had the Khutba read in his name, marking the foundation of the Nuhani dynasty.
- Dariya Khan Nuhani was only the Governor of Bihar (c.1495–1524) under the Lodis.

Related information about the Nuhani dynasty:

- Founder: Bahar Khan Nuhani
- Father: Dariya Khan Nuhani
- Title assumed: Sultan Muhammad
- Symbol of sovereignty: Khutba read in his name
- Nature: Short-lived Afghan dynasty in Bihar
- Territorial span: Bihar → parts up to Sambhal
- Political context: Weakening of Lodi authority
- Dariya Khan: Governor of Bihar under Sikandar Lodi
- Governorship period: c.1495–1524
- Major role: Maintained Afghan authority in Bihar
- Key linkage: Patron of Farid Khan Sur (Sher Shah Suri)
- After Bahar Khan: Afghan chiefs continued resistance in the east
- Historical significance: Bihar became an early Afghan power base, later enabling the rise of Sher Shah Suri

Q 43. Ans. A

Explanation:

- Mirza Aziz Koka: Appointed in 1580 under Akbar as governor of Bihar to restore order after jagirdar rebellions; along with Shahbaz Khan, he suppressed the revolt of Dalpat Sahi, though later internal conflicts were settled by Raja Todar Mal.
- Prince Parvez: Appointed in 1622 under Jahangir, he became the first Mughal prince to govern Bihar, and the town of Parvezabad (present-day Paleza) was named after him.
- Khan-i-Alam: Served as governor under Shah Jahan, but proved inefficient in administration and was recalled within a year of his appointment.
- Daud Khan Quraishi: Appointed under Aurangzeb, he became the first governor of Bihar during Aurangzeb's reign, defeated the Cheros of Palamau, extended Mughal control into Chotanagpur, and founded the town of Daudnagar.

Governors under the Mughals:

- Khan-i-Alam — Shah Jahan
- Shaista Khan — Shah Jahan → Aurangzeb
- Islam Khan — Jahangir / Shah Jahan (administrative continuity)
- Khan-i-Zaman — Akbar
- Khan-i-Dauran — Shah Jahan
- Shah Nawaz Khan — Shah Jahan

● Mir Jafar Astrabadi — Shah Jahan
● Murad Bakhsh (Prince) — Shah Jahan
● Aurangzeb (as Prince-Governor) — Shah Jahan
● Bahadur Kambu — Shah Jahan / Aurangzeb
● Shah Ali — Shah Jahan
● Abu Said Baqi Beg — Shah Jahan
● Ghairat Khan — Shah Jahan
● Sardar Khan — Shah Jahan
● Saif Khan — Shah Jahan
● Alahwardi Khan — Shah Jahan
● Azam Khan — Shah Jahan

Q 44. Ans. D

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The Uttarapatha (northern trade route) during the Mauryan period connected major urban centres such as Pushkalavati, Taxila, Mathura, Kausambi, Varanasi, Pataliputra, Champa, and Chandraketugarh, demonstrating a continuous east-west commercial corridor.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** Pataliputra, situated on the Ganga River, emerged as a major hub of riverine trade, where goods were transported by boats along the Ganga-based trade network, enhancing long-distance commerce.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** The main route was further strengthened by subsidiary routes connecting Pataliputra with Vaishali and Sravasti and extending towards Nepal, indicating its central role in integrating regional and trans-Himalayan trade networks.

Q 45. Ans. A

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Under the Bihar Panchayat Raj Act, 2006, the Gram Sabha is required to meet at least once every three months, ensuring regular grassroots participation and review of local governance matters.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The District Magistrate is empowered under the Bihar Panchayat Raj Act, 2006 to declare a Gram Panchayat area comprising a village or a group of contiguous villages with a population as nearly as 7000, through a notification in the District Gazette.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** The quorum for a Gram Sabha meeting is one-twentieth of the total members, not one-fortieth; however, one-fortieth applies only in the case of an adjourned meeting, if the original meeting fails to meet quorum.

Q 46. Ans. D

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The Bihar State Information Commission is a statutory body established by the Government of Bihar in June 2006 under Section 15

of the Right to Information Act, 2005. Its primary objective is to implement and uphold the provisions of the RTI Act.

- **Statement 2 is correct:** Shri Tripurari Sharan is the State Chief Information Commissioner of Bihar. He has directed two feature films and written a novel titled 'Madhopur Ka Ghar'.

Q 47. Ans. A

Explanation:

- First Lokayukta Sri Shridhar Vasudeva Sohoni (1973-1978)
- Second Lokayukta Mr. Justice Shyam Nandan Prasad Singh (1978-1983)
- Third Lokayukta Mr. Justice Triveni Sahai Mishra (1986-1991)
- Fourth Lokayukta Mr. Justice Syed Sarwar Ali (1991-1996)

Q 48. Ans. A

Explanation:

Administrative and Law Enforcement Overview

Category	Unit Type	Count
Regional Administration	Divisions	9
	Districts	38
	Sub-Divisions	101
Rural Governance	CD Blocks	534
	Panchayats	8,406
	Revenue Villages	45,103
Urban Infrastructure	Urban Agglomerations	14
	Total Towns	199
	Statutory Towns	139
Law Enforcement	Non-Statutory Towns	60
	Total Police Stations	44
	Civil Police Districts	40
	Railway Police Districts	4
	Total Police Stations	853
	Civil Police Stations	813
	Railway Police Stations	40

Q 49. Ans. B

Explanation:

- Under Article 243G of the Constitution, the 11th Schedule specifically lists exactly 29 subjects (including agriculture, rural housing, and primary education) to be devolved to Panchayati Raj Institutions.
- The Bihar Panchayati Raj Act, 2006, formally adopts

and mandates the devolution of powers across these 29 subjects to the three-tier rural local bodies.

Q 50. Ans. A

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Muzaffarpur is the administrative headquarters of the Tirhut Division. The Tirhut Division was created in 1908 when it was carved out of the Patna Division. The district of Muzaffarpur itself is older, having been established in 1875.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** There are six districts in this Tirhut division i.e Muzaffarpur, West Champaran (headquartered at Bettiah), East Champaran (headquartered at Motihari), Vaishali (headquartered at Hajipur), Sitamarhi and Sheohar. The administrative head of Tirhut Division is a Commissioner, a senior officer of the Indian Administrative Service (IAS).

Q 51. Ans. C

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The overall state average literacy rate for Bihar (2011) stands at 61.8%. Both the ST (51.1%) and SC (48.65%) populations fall significantly below this state average..
- **Statement 2 is correct:** In Bihar, the overall literacy rate for Scheduled Tribes (ST) is 51.1%, which is higher than the Scheduled Castes (SC) literacy rate of 48.65%.

Q 52. Ans. B

Explanation:

- President's Rule was imposed in Bihar for the first time on June 29, 1968, and it remained in effect until February 26, 1969.
- This occurred during a period of massive political instability in the state following the 1967 elections. The government led by Chief Minister Bhola Paswan Shastri collapsed, leading to the imposition of central rule.
- The Governor of Bihar at the time of this first imposition was Nityanand Kanungo.
- President's Rule has been imposed in Bihar a total of 8 times so far..
- Last/Most Recent Imposition: 2005 (From March 7, 2005, to November 24, 2005). The Governor at this time was Buta Singh, and it happened due to a hung assembly where no party could form a government.
- Most Frequent CM: Bhola Paswan Shastri holds the unique distinction of being the Chief Minister during three separate instances when President's Rule was recommended/imposed (1968, 1969, and 1971).

Q 53. Ans. B

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** After the bifurcation of Bihar in 2000, the state adopted the Gaur/bison as its state animal to represent its agrarian economy and rural livelihood

- **Statement 2 is correct:** Marigold is declared as the state flower of Bihar
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** The state tree of Bihar is the peepal, not the Ashok tree.

Q 54. Ans. B

Explanation:

- **Assertion (A) is true:** Bihar's decadal population growth declined from 28.43% (1991–2001) to 25.42% (2001–2011), indicating a slowing growth rate, although the population continued to rise in absolute terms.
- **Reason (R) is true:** Bihar's share in India's population increased from 8.07% in 2001 to 8.60% in 2011, reflecting its growing demographic weight at the national level due to its large and still rapidly increasing population.
- While both statements are correct, the increase in Bihar's share of India's population does not explain the decline in its decadal growth rate; the two trends are independent demographic observations, hence (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).

Q 55. Ans. D

Explanation:

- The first Doordarshan Kendra in Bihar was established in Muzaffarpur on August 14, 1978, marking the formal beginning of television broadcasting in the state.
- Doordarshan Kendra in Patna, was established much in 1990.
- Doordarshan is a part of the Prasar Bharti (India's largest public broadcaster) and is the largest broadcasting company in India.

Q 56. Ans. A

Explanation:

- Both the Assertion (A) and the Reason (R) are correct, and the Reason (R) provides a valid explanation for the Assertion (A).
- According to official Census data for Bihar, the Child Sex Ratio (0–6 years) in 2001 stood at 944 in rural areas and 924 in urban areas, reflecting a rural–urban differential of 20 points. By 2011, these figures declined to 938 (rural) and 912 (urban), thereby widening the differential to 26 points.
- The rural Child Sex Ratio registered a decline of 6 points, whereas the urban ratio experienced a steeper decline of 12 points, thereby substantiating Assertion (A). The increase in the rural–urban gap from 20 to 26 points demonstrates that the deterioration in the urban Child Sex Ratio was more pronounced than in rural areas. Hence, the Reason (R) accurately explains the Assertion (A).

Q 57. Ans. D

Explanation:

- Agriculture is the backbone of Bihar's economy, and

as per Census data of 2011, 77% of the workforce is employed in the agricultural production generating nearly 24.84% of the State Domestic Product (including forestry and fishing).

Q 58. Ans. A

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Jat-Jatin is a popular folk dance in Bihar. It is most popular in North Bihar, namely the Mithila and Koshi districts. It is a woman's dance and should be performed on a moonlit night during the rainy season.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** It is never a solo dance. It is a duet/dialogue dance representing the lovers Jat and Jatin. Traditionally, it is performed exclusively by women, with one woman dressing as the male lead (Jat). The dance depicts their romance, quarrels, and reconciliation through simple rhythmic steps and folk songs.

Q 59. Ans. A

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** The main design outline of Sujani is done with thick chain stitching Highlight. The cloth used for Sujani embroidery is made of fine muslin. The color of the base fabric is white or red. The outline of the main design is highlighted with thick chain stitching. The interior of the design is filled with threads of vibrant colors. Raw materials: Cotton (textile), cotton thread, embroidery thread.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** Sujini embroidery, a women's craft, narrates stories of women's lives, social issues, and everyday experiences. Themes include domestic abuse, dowry, girls' education, and female infanticide. Motifs from nature, religion, and daily life are also used, featuring animals, flowers, and symbols like the sun, clouds, and moon.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** Sujni embroidery received the Geographical Indication (GI) tag in 2006, recognising its unique regional identity and traditional craftsmanship from Bihar.

Q 60. Ans. C

Explanation:

- **Region & Community:** Sama Chakeva is celebrated in the Mithila region (north Bihar and parts of Nepal) by the Maithili-speaking community; it highlights the brother-sister bond and preserves Maithili cultural identity.
- **Duration:** Begins a day after Chhath Puja, continues for ~10 days, and culminates on Kartik Purnima.
- **Rituals:** Women, especially young girls, make clay idols of Sama, Chakeva, and related figures.
- **Mythology:** Based on the legend of Sama (daughter of Lord Krishna) who was falsely accused and turned into a bird; her brother Chakeva restored her human form.

Q 61. Ans. C

Explanation:

Chhath Puja is a powerful and deeply spiritual Vedic festival dedicated to Surya Dev (Sun God) and Chhathi Maiya (Goddess Usha). Celebrated predominantly in Bihar, Uttar Pradesh, Jharkhand, and parts of Nepal, it reflects India's ancestral reverence for nature, water, and cosmic energy.

- **Nahay Khay:** The festival begins with a holy bath in rivers or ponds. The devotee (known as Vrati) prepares a satvik meal of lauki (bottle gourd), rice, and chana dal. The meal is consumed once and cooked in bronze or earthen utensils on a wood or cow dung stove
- **Kharna:** Devotees observe a strict fast without water (nirjala vrat) from sunrise to moonrise
- After sunset, kheer made with jaggery and rice, roti, and bananas are offered to Chhathi Maiya and consumed by the devotee. This marks the beginning of a 36-hour nirjala fast observed till sunrise on Usha Arghya
- **Sandhya Arghya:** As the sun sets, devotees offer arghya while standing waist-deep in water. The soop (bamboo basket) is filled with thekua, sugarcane, bananas, turmeric root, coconut, diyas, and seasonal fruits.
- **Usha Arghya:** The final ritual occurs before sunrise, where devotees offer water and prasad to the rising sun. After arghya, the fast is broken, and prasad is shared with family, neighbours, and visitors. This concludes Chhath with gratitude, healing, and peace

Q 62. Ans. D

Explanation:

- Bidesia is Bihar's iconic folk theatre, famously conceptualised and rejuvenated by Bhikhari Thakur (the "Bhojpuri Shakespeare"). Its core theme is Viraha, the emotional pain of a woman whose husband migrates to far-off lands (Pardes) for work.
- **Performance style:** The central characters are the Nat and Nati. Traditionally, the Nati is a male performer who wears a Ghaghra Choli, while the Nat wears a colorful Dolangi Dhoti, Kameez, and Pagri.
- **Musical ensemble:** The performance is driven by a high-energy acoustic ensemble including percussion like the Dholak, Nagara, and Khajri (tambourine-like), paired with Jhanj (cymbals/majira) and the hand-pumped Harmonium.

Q 63. Ans. B

Explanation:

- **Assertion (A) is correct:** A defining characteristic of Patna Kalam is its lack of landscapes, foregrounds, or backgrounds. The focus is entirely on the central subject (e.g., a craftsman or a bazaar scene), often leaving the surrounding paper or mica blank.
- **Reason (R) is correct:** Patna Kalam artists were originally descendants of Mughal court painters who migrated first to Murshidabad and eventually to Patna, modifying their royal style into regional art.

- **Why (R) does not explain (A):** The specific reason Patna Kalam artists abandoned backgrounds was due to the shift in patronage. British officials (the “Company” patrons) demanded quick, documentary-style illustrations of local Indian life. To meet this mass-market demand affordably and rapidly, artists eliminated the time-consuming, expensive backgrounds characteristic of Mughal art. Reason (R) merely states an evolution occurred but fails to explain the economic and patron-driven cause behind this specific stylistic change.
- **Additional information:**
 - ✓ **Origin & migration:** After the withdrawal of royal patronage under Aurangzeb (late 17th century), Mughal painters moved to Murshidabad; later, post-decline of the Nawab of Bengal (mid-18th century), they migrated to Bihar (Patna, Danapur, Arrah), leading to the emergence of Patna Kalam.
 - ✓ **Subject matter:** Shift from Mughal courtly themes to everyday life—bazaar scenes, artisans, tradesmen, festivals, and local ceremonies.
 - ✓ **Technique & shading:** Light-coloured sketches with life-like representation; advanced shading for 3D effect; use of Kajli Seahi (direct brushwork without pencil outlines).
 - ✓ **Materials:** Natural dyes from plants, bark, flowers, and metals; surfaces included paper, glass, mica, and ivory (to suit British patrons).
 - ✓ **Artists:** Sewak Ram (noted for large festival scenes), Hulas Lal, Shiva Lal, Shiva Dayal Lal, Mahadeo Lal, and Ishwari Prasad Verma (the last master of Patna Kalam).

Q 64. Ans. B

Explanation:

- Katarni Rice is the most prevalent, ceremonial, and finest quality scented rice of Bihar, India. The word “Katarni” literally means an awl with a hook at the end for sewing. Awl is a pointed tool for making holes in wood or leather. In 2018, Katarni Rice were designated as a Geographical Indicator.
- The finest texture of Silk springing out from the essence of nature and known as the ‘Queen of all fabrics’, Bhagalpuri Silk is very well known for its unique and striking resilience and superior quality. In 2013, Bhagalpuri Silk were designated as a Geographical Indicator.
- Madhubani painting, also referred to as Mithila Art (as it flourishes in the Mithila region of Bihar), is characterised by line drawings filled in by bright colours and contrasts or patterns. In 2007, Madhubani Paintings were designated as a Geographical Indicator.
- Khatwa, an appliqué work that originated in Bihar, was locally used to create decorative tents, canopies, wall handbags, and home furnishings. Khatwa is an art of creating designs and narratives on fabric, using fabric.

In 2016, Khatwa were designated as a Geographical Indicator.

Q 65. Ans. A

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The present structure of Padri Ki Haveli (St. Mary’s Church) was redesigned in 1772 by Venetian architect Tirreto, although the original church dates back to 1713, making it the oldest church in Bihar.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** The building is primarily Portuguese/Indo-European in style with colonial ecclesiastical features, not purely Italian; it has also survived major historical events such as the attack by Mir Qasim (1763) and the Revolt of 1857, reflecting its architectural resilience.

Q 66. Ans. A

Explanation:

Soil Type	Districts	Key Features
Balthar Soil	Kaimur	Sandy, iron-rich with a reddish-yellow hue, is suitable for crops like jowar, bajra, and arhar
Tal Soil	Patna, Munger	Heavy clayey soil with high water retention, ideal for pulses, oilseeds, and wheat
Terai Soil	Champan, Kishanganj	Fertile, sandy and calcareous soil, grey to light yellow, suitable for sugarcane, jute, and rice
Bal Sundari Soil	Saharsa, East & West Champaran	Sandy loam, alkaline in nature and rich in lime, supporting crops like maize, mango, litchi and tobacco

Q 67. Ans. B

Explanation:

- The Sone River enters Bihar through the Nauhatta block of Rohtas district, marking its entry from the plateau region into the Gangetic plains.
- The Sone River is also called the ‘Hiranyavah’, and the Indrapuri Barrage at Dehri is one of the longest barrages in the world.
- Its length in Bihar is 202 km out of its total length of 784 km (MP: 500 km and UP: 82 km).

Q 68. Ans. C

Explanation:

- As the Ganga flows through Bihar, it traverses twelve districts: Buxar, Bhojpur, Patna, Saran, Vaishali, Samastipur, Begusarai, Khagaria, Munger, Bhagalpur, Katihar, and Lakhisarai.
- Among these, the Patna district has the longest stretch

of the river, extending over 99 kilometres, making it the most extensive district-wise segment of the Ganga in Bihar.

- It flows for a total of 445 kilometres across Bihar, and it enters at Chausa in Buxar before leaving through the Katihar district.

Q 69. Ans. D

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Barauni Refinery, located in Bihar, is one of the major oil refineries in India. It is operated by Indian Oil Corporation Limited (IOC). Established with assistance from the Soviet Union at a cost of ₹49.40 crore, the refinery commenced operations in July 1964.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** Barauni Dairy is a fully co-operative organisation established in 1959.
- It is a major co-operative milk union in Bihar and acts as a key component of the Bihar State Co-operative Milk Producers' Federation Limited (COMFED).
- **Statement 3 is correct:** Teghra is known for its small agro-based industrial cluster, including rice mills and other agricultural processing units. Agro-processing is considered key for regional development and reducing post-harvest losses.

Q 70. Ans. B

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The world-famous Magahi Paan of the Magadha region in Bihar stands tall in all parameters of taste, pungency and softness. This high-grade Magahi Paan, grown in clay loam soil in the regions of Nawada, Nalanda, Gaya and Aurangabad are cultivated by a certain community called the 'Chaurasia'.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** The Magahi Paan which was favoured by the noble families of Lucknow and Bengal in the 18th and 19th centuries and associated with many famous stories on their lives received the prestigious Geographical Indication Tag (GI) in 2018 for its distinctive pungency, softness, sweetness and its tendency to melt in the mouth upon consumption.

Q 71. Ans. A

Explanation:

Division	Headquarters	Districts
Patna	Patna	Patna, Bhojpur, Bhabhua, Rohtas, Buxar, Nalanda
Magadh	Gaya	Gaya, Jehanabad, Arwal, Aurangabad, Nawada
Tirhut	Muzaffarpur	Muzaffarpur, East Champaran, West Champaran, Sitamarhi, Vaishali, Sheohar

Saran	Chapara	Saran, Siwan, Gopalganj
Bhagalpur	Bhagalpur	Bhagalpur, Banka
Munger	Munger	Munger, Begusarai, Khagaria, Lakhisarai, Sheikhpura, Jamui
Purnea	Purnea	Purnea, Katihar, Araria, Kishanganj
Darbhanga	Darbhanga	Darbhanga, Madhubani, Samastipur
Koshi	Saharsa	Saharsa, Madhepura, Supaul

Q 72. Ans. C

Explanation:

- As per the 2011 Census of India, Patna ranks as the 15th most populous district in the country, with a total population of approximately 5,838,465.
- Thane district in Maharashtra holds the 1st rank.
- **Urbanisation:** Patna is the most urbanised district in Bihar. Approximately 43.07% of its population lives in urban areas, which is higher than the state average of 11.3%. The least urbanised is Samastipur at ~3.5%.
- **Literacy Rate:** Patna has a total literacy rate of 70.68%, which ranks it 2nd in Bihar. Rohtas holds the 1st rank at 73.37%.
- **Sex Ratio:** Patna's sex ratio is 897 females per 1000 males, which is lower than the Bihar state average of 918. Gopalganj holds the top rank at 1021.

Q 73. Ans. A

Explanation:

- Bhojpuri is a Bihari language, spoken primarily in the western part of the state of Bihar and the eastern part of the state of Uttar Pradesh.
- **Standard Bhojpuri** is considered as the purest form of the language, it is spoken primarily in the historical Shahabad region of Bihar (modern-day Bhojpur, Buxar, Rohtas, and Kaimur) and extends into the Ballia and Ghazipur districts of Uttar Pradesh.
- **Northern Bhojpuri** is common in the areas of Gorakhpur, Deoria, Kushinagar, and Maharajganj districts and Basti regions in the state of Uttar Pradesh.
- **Western Bhojpuri** is spoken in the districts of Faizabad, Azamgarh, Jaunpur, Varanasi, the western half of Ghazipur and South-Gangetic Mirzapur in the state of Uttar Pradesh.
- **Nagpuria Bhojpuri** is the southernmost dialect, spoken in the Chota Nagpur Plateau of Jharkhand, particularly in the parts of Palamau and Ranchi. It has more Magahi influence. It is sometimes referred to as 'Sadari' as well.
- **Madhesi** is spoken in the district of Champaran in the state of Bihar. The word means "middle," as it acts as a linguistic bridge between Bhojpuri and Maithili/Bajjika.

Q 74. Ans. D**Explanation:**

- Sugarcane (*Saccharum officinarum* L.) is one of the most important cash crop which is cultivated in the tropical and subtropical regions globally and contributes 70% of world sugar production and provides raw material for many other by products. Among all districts of Bihar, West Champaran is the highest sugarcane growing districts of the state.
- During the survey of different sugarcane localities in West Champaran district was observed that the incidence of smut, wilt and pokkah boeng diseases increased and affected several popular commercial varieties.
- Yellow Vein Mosaic is a famous viral disease, but it does not affect sugarcane. It is the most destructive disease affecting Okra (Bhindi), transmitted by the whitefly.

Q 75. Ans. B**Explanation:**

- Barauni Refinery was commissioned in 1964 with an initial capacity of 1.0 MMTPA and through various revamps the crude processing capacity has been augmented to 6.0 MMTPA in 2002.
- CRU (Catalytic Reformer Unit) was commissioned in 1997 for the production of unleaded motor spirit.
- Post Barauni Refinery Expansion, the refinery capacity was augmented to 6.0 MMTPA crude with 16% High Sulphur crude processing capability.

Q 76. Ans. B**Explanation:**

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** The Kamla River originates from the Mahabharat Range of the Himalayas in Nepal, not from the Someshwar Range, and enters Bihar at Jaynagar in Madhubani district.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The Kamla River has major tributaries such as Soni, Dhauri, Balan, and Trisula, and in Bihar, it splits into several channels, with one joining the Bagmati River in Khagaria and another merging with the Kosi River.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** The Mahananda River originates from Mahaldiram Hill in the Darjeeling district of West Bengal and later flows along the India-Bangladesh border before entering Bihar. The Fulahar River (local name in Bihar), which is the right channel of the Mahananda river system, flows through Bihar and outflows into the Ganga on the left bank opposite Rajmahal.
- **Statement 4 is incorrect:** The Mahananda River enters Bihar in Kishanganj district, not Katihar; it then flows along the boundary of Bihar and West Bengal through Kishanganj, Purnea, and Katihar districts, and finally joins the Ganga near Manihari (Katihar). Tributaries in Bihar:

- ✓ Left bank tributaries: Nagar, Tangan, and Punarbhaba
- ✓ Right bank tributaries: Kalindi, Balasan, and Mechi

Q 77. Ans. A**Explanation:**

Mineral	Location
Coal	Rajmahal Coalfield
Limestone	Kaimur (Bhabhua), Munger, Rohtas
Mica	Nawada
Quartz / Silica sand	Bhagalpur, Jamui, Munger, Nalanda
Quartzite	Lakhisarai, Munger, Nalanda
Talc / Soapstone Steatite	Munger
Bauxite	Munger, Rohtas
China Clay	Bhagalpur, Munger
Felspar	Gaya, Jamui, Munger
Fireclay	Bhagalpur, Purnea
Gold	Jamui
Granite	Bhagalpur, Jehanabad, Gaya, Jamui
Iron ore (hematite)	Bhagalpur
Iron Ore (Magnetite)	Gaya, Jamui
Lead - Zinc	Banka, Rohtas
Pyrites	Rohtas
Dolomite	Rohtas, Kaimur hilly region
Slate Stone	Munger (Jamalpur, Kajra region)

Q 78. Ans. B**Explanation:**

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** Kanwar Lake was formed as an oxbow lake due to fluvial processes involving meandering, erosion, and deposition of the Burhi Gandak River, leading to the cut-off of a river loop.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** Kanwar Lake, located in Begusarai (Bihar), is Asia's largest freshwater oxbow lake, once covering about 7,000 hectares and serving as a major habitat for migratory birds and aquatic biodiversity.
 - ✓ It was declared a protected area in 1986 and later a bird sanctuary, though it has degraded due to encroachment and disruption of natural inflow.

Q 79. Ans. A**Explanation:**

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** Kanwar Lake was declared a bird sanctuary in 1989, not 2020; however, it was designated as a Ramsar Site in 2020.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** The sanctuary attracts migratory birds mainly during the winter season, not summer, as birds migrate to escape the extreme cold of regions like Siberia.

- **Statement 3 is correct:** Major birds sighted around Kabartal wetland include Northern Shoveler, Lesser Adjutant, Steppe Eagle, Greater Spotted Eagle, Grey-headed Lapwing, and Western Yellow Wagtail.

Q 80. Ans. D

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** The northern floodplain belt of Bihar, including Supaul, Saharsa, Darbhanga and Madhubani, is dominated by new alluvial (Khadar) soils, which are light-textured, frequently renewed by floods, and highly suitable for crops like paddy, maize and jute.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** Patna, Nalanda and Bhojpur lie in the old alluvial (Bhangar) zone, where soils are older, relatively compact, often contain kankar, and are not regularly replenished by fresh river deposits.

Q 81. Ans. B

Explanation:

- Jhunjhunwa Pahad is located in Pawai village of Aurangabad district in Bihar, and is known for a mysterious rock that produces a metallic sound when struck.
- Pawai village is also associated with Raja Narayan Singh, who came from the family tree of Prithviraj Chauhan. Facts associated with him are:
 - ✓ Powerful zamindar; became Raja in 1764
 - ✓ Revolt against the British: 1770–1782
 - ✓ Refused Malguzari tax during the famine
 - ✓ Defeated/ resisted the British; blocked entry to Varanasi (1778)
 - ✓ Supported Chait Singh revolt (1781)
 - ✓ Called “the first enemy of the British”
 - ✓ Arrested and sent to Dhaka (1786)
 - ✓ Died soon after release.

Q 82. Ans. A

Explanation:

- Kakolat Waterfall is located near Kakolat hill, about 22 km southeast of Nawada and is formed by the confluence of seven streams from the Koderma plateau. This fall is often called the Niagara of Bihar.
- Jiarkund Waterfall is located in the Bhojpur district of Bihar, situated on the Phulwaria River.
- Durgavati Waterfall is situated in Kaimur district, where the Durgavati River falls from about 300 feet, and it is also known as Khadarkoh Waterfall.
- The Okharin Waterfall, with a height of 90 metres, is situated on the Gopath River in the Rohtas district of Bihar.

Q 83. Ans. A

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Gidheshwar Hills extend across Munger and Jamui districts in South Bihar. The

Gidheshwar Nath Temple is a major Shaiva Tirtha Sthala located near it.

- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** These belong to the Chotanagpur plateau extension, and they are tall hills that reach up to 500 meters and are considered part of the Vindhya Range.

Q 84. Ans. A

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Kusheshwarsthan is located in the Darbhanga district, where it serves as an important habitat for migratory birds and a major centre of fish farming. It was officially declared a Wildlife Bird Sanctuary in 1994. During the winter, rare birds like Dalmatian Pelican, Indian Darter, Bar-headed goose, and Siberian Crane can be spotted.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** Anupam Lake is located in the Kaimur district, which lies in the southern plateau–alluvial transition zone.

Q 85. Ans. C

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The Gandak River originates from the Nubine Himal glacier in the Mustang region of Nepal, which is near the border with Tibet and flows through Nepal before entering India. It flows through West Champaran, East Champaran, Muzaffarpur, Gopalganj, Siwan, Saran, Vaishali and Hajipur districts in Bihar.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** The Gandak does not join the Ganga near Begusarai; it confluences with the Ganga near Hajipur in Bihar.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** The species found in the Gandak River include the Gangetic dolphin, Smooth-coated otter, Gharial, Mugger, Red-crowned roofed turtle, Indian narrow-headed softshell turtle, and Lesser adjutant.

Q 86. Ans. A

Explanation:

- **Assertion (A) is true:** In Agro-Climatic Zone II, soils are largely non-calcareous, with dominant types including recent alluvial terai soil and non-calcareous alluvial soils, and they are generally moderately acidic to neutral, with very acidic soils in the north-eastern parts.
- **Reason (R) is true:** The Kosi and Mahananda rivers originate from Himalayan regions that are rich in acidic minerals and not lime-rich, unlike rivers such as Gandak and Ghagra, which pass through more calcareous/sedimentary Tethyan rock zones.
- The geological origin and mineral composition of river catchments (R) directly determine the soil characteristics in Zone II (A), leading to the formation of non-calcareous and relatively acidic soils.
- Agro-Climatic Zone II covers 8 districts:

- ✓ Purnea
- ✓ Katihar
- ✓ Saharsa
- ✓ Supaul
- ✓ Madhepura
- ✓ Khagaria
- ✓ Araria
- ✓ Kishanganj

Q 87. Ans. B

Explanation:

- Despite being one of the most powerful and influential politicians from Bihar in the 1970s and serving as the Union Railway Minister, Lalit Narayan Mishra was never the Chief Minister of the state. It was his younger brother, Dr. Jagannath Mishra, who went on to serve as the Chief Minister of Bihar three times.
- Daroga Prasad Rai: Served as the 10th Chief Minister of Bihar (February 1970 – December 1970).
- Chandra Shekhar Singh: Served as the 22nd Chief Minister from August 1983 to March 1985.
- Bhagwat Jha Azad: Served as the 23rd Chief Minister from February 1988 to March 1989. He represented the Bhagalpur constituency for six terms; he is also notably the father of Kirti Azad (a member of India's 1983 Cricket World Cup-winning team).

Additional facts:

- First Chief Minister: Dr. Shri Krishna Sinha (Sri Babu). He led the first Congress ministry in 1937 and served continuously from 1946 until his death in 1961. Under his tenure, Bihar became the first state in India to abolish the Zamindari system.
- First Non-Congress CM: Mahamaya Prasad Sinha (March 1967 – January 1968). He led the Samyukta Vidhayak Dal (SVD) coalition.
- First Dalit (SC) CM: Bhola Paswan Shastri (1968). He served three separate terms as CM; notably, his terms frequently coincided with the imposition of President's Rule in the state.
- First OBC CM: Satish Prasad Singh (1968). He belonged to the Koeri community.
- First Muslim CM: Abdul Ghafoor (1973 – 1975). He was the Chief Minister during the peak of the 1974 JP Movement (Total Revolution).
- First Female CM: Rabri Devi (1997).
- Longest Total Tenure: Nitish Kumar. He has surpassed Dr. Shri Krishna Sinha in terms of total days served in office.
- Maximum Oaths Taken: Nitish Kumar holds the record for taking the Chief Ministerial oath the highest number of times (9 times).

- Shortest Single Tenure: Satish Prasad Singh. He served for exactly 5 days (Jan 28 - Feb 1, 1968). He was installed purely as a stopgap arrangement to nominate B.P. Mandal to the Legislative Council.
- Second Shortest Tenure: Nitish Kumar's first term in 2000 lasted only 7 days before he resigned due to a lack of majority.
- Bindeshwari Prasad Mandal: He served as the 7th CM of Bihar for just 31 days in 1968. He is most famous nationally for later chairing the Mandal Commission (Socially and Educationally Backward Classes Commission).
- Karpoori Thakur: Served twice as CM. His second tenure (1977-1979) is historically significant for implementing the Karpoori Formula, which pioneered a layered reservation system for Backwards Classes (26% quota) long before the Mandal Commission was implemented nationally.
- Jagannath Mishra: He was the last Congress Chief Minister of Bihar to complete a nearly full term (1980-1985). He served as CM three times and made Urdu the second official language of Bihar in 1981.
- Jitan Ram Manjhi: The third Dalit Chief Minister of Bihar (after Bhola Paswan Shastri and Ram Sundar Das), serving from May 2014 to February 2015.

Q 88. Ans. D

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** The Inland Waterways Authority of India (IWAI) has developed permanent terminals at Patna and Kalughat, not at Bhagalpur, Manihari, and Buxar.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** Floating terminals have been developed at Bhagalpur, Manihari, and Buxar, not at Patna and Kalughat. The Ganga - Bhagirathi - Hooghly river system between Haldia (Sagar) and Prayagraj (1620 km) was declared as National Waterway-1 (NW-1) in 1986.

Q 89. Ans. A

Explanation:

- **Assertion (A) is true:** Out of the 38 districts of Bihar, 8 districts fall in Seismic Zone V, which represents the highest level of earthquake risk, with districts like Madhubani and Supaul entirely falling in this zone.
 - ✓ Zone IV: 24 districts
 - ✓ Zone III: 6 districts
- **Reason (R) is true:** Bihar is situated close to the Himalayan tectonic plate boundary, where active geological movements and six sub-surface fault lines extending towards the Gangetic plains increase the likelihood of seismic disturbances.

Q 90. Ans. B

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** The Ahar–Pyne system is an ancient water management system of South Bihar, in use for over 2,000 years since the Magadh period, especially prevalent in the region around Gaya, Nalanda, and Kaimur.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The system comprises Ahars (man-made reservoirs) that store water and Pynes (channels) that divert and distribute water from rivers or rain-fed sources to fields, ensuring efficient irrigation.
 - ✓ Additionally, the system plays a crucial role in flood control by diverting excess water, drought mitigation through storage, and improving agricultural productivity, as the stored water is nutrient-rich and enhances soil fertility and crop yield; recent efforts focus on its revival and modernisation.

Q 91. Ans. C

Explanation:

- Sangam Kumar Sahoo was sworn in as the 47th Chief Justice of the Patna High Court on January 7, 2026.
- The oath was administered by the Governor of Bihar, marking an important judicial appointment in the state.
- He succeeded Justice Pavankumar Bhimappa Bajanthri.

Q 92. Ans. C

Explanation:

- In the Union Budget 2026–27, the Government of India announced the setting up of a ship repair centre in Patna (Bihar) and Varanasi (Uttar Pradesh), as part of its broader initiative to strengthen inland waterways and related infrastructure.
- The facility will be developed as part of a “ship repair ecosystem” to support vessels and cargo boats operating on inland waterways, particularly along National Waterway-1 on the Ganga River.
- The Patna facility is being developed by the Inland Waterways Authority of India (IWAI).

Q 93. Ans. D

Explanation:

- Panchayati Raj department was awarded the prestigious national-level SKOCH “Order of Merit” award for its effective and successful grassroots implementation of the Chief Minister’s ambitious Jal-Jeevan-Hariyali campaign.
- To win this award, the Panchayati Raj Department executed highly specific, data-driven grassroots infrastructure:
 - ✓ Well rejuvenation: They successfully renovated and restored over 25,579 public wells across the state’s panchayats.

- ✓ Groundwater recharge: They constructed 19,033 soak pits (sokhthas) adjacent to these wells to ensure permanent groundwater recharging.
- ✓ Infrastructure tech: They mandated rooftop rainwater harvesting systems on the newly built Panchayat Sarkar Bhawans.
- ✓ Digital transparency: The entire operation was strictly monitored and geo-tagged using the central e-Gram Swaraj portal.

Q 94. Ans. B

Explanation:

- Bihar is set to get its first Water Sports Academy at Odhni Dam in Banka district.
- The academy is being set up in direct collaboration with the Government of Madhya Pradesh and the Bhopal-based Indian Canoeing and Kayaking Association.
- The academy will operate as a State Centre of Excellence specifically for Canoeing, Kayaking, and Rowing.

Q 95. Ans. A

Explanation:

- Dr. Divya Jyoti received the National Award at the Pratibha Samman Samaroh-2026 for her notable contributions to education and social empowerment, especially her efforts to promote quality education for girls and underprivileged communities.
- She was honoured at the Pratibha Sammaan Samaroh-2026, organized by the Bharat Pratibha Sammaan Council at the NDMC Convention Centre in New Delhi.
- The award was presented by Padma Shri Uma Tuli.

Q 96. Ans. D

Explanation:

- Bihar government launched a Mega Mass Drug Administration (MDA) campaign aimed at eliminating filariasis, a debilitating mosquito-borne disease, as part of a wider national target to wipe out the illness by 2027. The campaign was inaugurated by the State Health Minister, Mangal Pandey, at Urja Auditorium in Shastri Nagar.
- Bihar is using two distinct drug regimens:
 - ✓ Two-drug regimen (DA): Albendazole + DEC (used in 19 districts).
 - ✓ Triple-drug regimen (IDA): Ivermectin + DEC + Albendazole (used in 15 high-burden districts like Muzaffarpur, Gaya, and Saran)

Q 97. Ans. C

Explanation:

- Finance Minister Bijendra Prasad Yadav presented a record budget of ₹3,47,589.76 crore for FY 2026-27 on February 3, 2026. This is the largest budget in Bihar’s history, growing by nearly ₹30,700 crore over the previous year.

- Vision: The budget is guided by the 'Saat Nischay-3' roadmap (2025-2030), aiming to create 1 crore jobs and double per-capita income.
- Top allocation: The Education sector received the highest share of the budget at ₹68,216 crore, followed by Health and Social Welfare.
- Fiscal target: The fiscal deficit is estimated at 2.99% of the GSDP, staying within the prescribed 3% limit.

Q 98. Ans. B

Explanation:

- The Royal Bhutan Buddhist Temple was inaugurated at Rajgir in Bihar by Bhutan's Prime Minister Tshering Tobgay along with Union Minister Kiren Rijiju.

Q 99. Ans. B

Explanation:

- The 'Rajendra Sonia' turmeric variety is primarily cultivated in Samastipur district and is known for its high curcumin content (7-8%), making it superior to many other varieties.
- Due to its unique quality and commercial potential, efforts are underway to secure a Geographical Indication (GI) tag, while the district has also been designated as a turmeric hub under the One District One Product scheme.

Q 100. Ans. C

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The Priority Corridor of the Patna Metro includes a 3.6 km elevated stretch connecting New Pataliputra Bus Terminal and Bhootnath Station, marking the initial operational segment.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The Phase-I network (31.9 km) comprises both elevated and underground sections, with nearly half of the route elevated, reflecting a mixed infrastructure approach for efficient urban transit.

Q 101. Ans. B

Explanation:

- Lieutenant General (Retired) Syed Ata Hasnain was sworn in as the 43rd Governor of Bihar at a ceremony held at Lok Bhavan.
- The oath was administered by Chief Justice Sangam Kumar Sahu, in the presence of key dignitaries including the Chief Minister and Deputy Chief Ministers, reflecting the constitutional significance of the gubernatorial office.
- Syed Ata Hasnain became the first former Indian Army officer to serve as the Governor of Bihar.

Q 102. Ans. C

Explanation:

- IIT Patna signed an agreement with Lincoln University, Australia to strengthen international academic

collaboration and research excellence.

- The partnership focuses on knowledge exchange, innovation, and joint research initiatives, enhancing global academic engagement.

Q 103. Ans. C

Explanation:

- Nitish Kumar took oath as the Chief Minister of Bihar for the 10th time, marking a record tenure in the state's political history.
- This reflects his sustained political influence and leadership continuity in Bihar governance.

Q 104. Ans. B

Explanation:

- Anu Kumari belongs to Buxar district of Bihar and was a member of India's Blind Women's T20 World Cup winning team in 2025.
- She was honoured by the state government for her contribution, highlighting Bihar's growing presence in national and international sports achievements.

Additional Facts on Blind Women's T20 World Cup 2025:	
● 1st (Inaugural) Women's T20 World Cup for the Blind held in November 2025	
● Final played at Colombo, Sri Lanka on 23 November 2025	
● India won the title; defeated Nepal in the final	
● India won by 7 wickets	
● Captain: Deepika T. C. (Karnataka)	
● Player of the Match (Final): Phula Saren	
● Tournament organized under World Organizing Committee (Chair: Meenakshi Lekhi)	
● Player of the tournament:	
✓ B1 Category (Completely Blind): Susma Tamang (Nepal)	
✓ B2 Category (Partially Blind): Mankeshi Chaudhary (Nepal)	
✓ B3 Category (Partially Sighted): Mehreen Ali (Pakistan)	

Q 105. Ans. A

Explanation:

- The Mandar Festival, also known as Bounsi Mela, is organised in the Banka district of Bihar near Mandar Hill.
- It is a significant cultural and religious event associated with Makar Sankranti, attracting pilgrims from multiple states.
- During the Bounsi Mela, devotees traditionally take a holy dip in the 'Paap Harini' (Paparni) pond located at the base of the Mandar hill.

Q 106. Ans. B**Explanation:**

- The Gokul Reservoir is located in Buxar district on the southern bank of the Ganga River and has been designated as a Ramsar Site, recognising its importance as a wetland of international significance.
- It supports biodiversity conservation and ecological balance.
- Other Ramsar Sites in Bihar:
 - ✓ Udaipur Jheel (West Champaran)
 - ✓ Kabar Taal (Begusarai)
 - ✓ Nagi Bird Sanctuary (Jamui)
 - ✓ Nakti Bird Sanctuary (Jamui)

Q 107. Ans. C**Explanation:**

- The NDA secured 202 seats out of a total of 243 in the Bihar Assembly Elections 2025, achieving a clear majority well above the required 122 seats.
- This enabled the formation of the government under Nitish Kumar.

Q 108. Ans. B**Explanation:**

- Bihar has received in-principle approval to host the first National Youth Games in 2028, marking a major boost to its sports infrastructure and youth development initiatives.
- The state is also establishing an Olympic fencing training centre to nurture talent.

Q 109. Ans. B**Explanation:**

- The GI Mahotsav 2025 was inaugurated in Patna, where it showcased a diverse range of Geographical Indication (GI) products from across India.
- The event aimed to promote traditional craftsmanship, MSMEs, and region-specific products, thereby enhancing awareness and market opportunities.

Q 110. Ans. B**Explanation:**

- The Kajra Solar Power Plant is located in the Suryagarha block of Lakhisarai district and was inaugurated by Nitish Kumar on 6 October 2025.
- Developed in two phases at an estimated cost of over ₹2,800 crore, the project will reach a total generation capacity of 301 MW with 523 MWh Battery Energy Storage System (BESS) by 2027.

Q 111. Ans. C**Explanation:**

- The Indira Gandhi Institute of Medical Sciences (IGIMS), Patna received the 'Excellence Award' from the Department of Health Research (DHR) under the

Ministry of Health and Family Welfare.

- IGIMS was the only institute from Bihar to receive this specific MRU Excellence Award.

Q 112. Ans. B**Explanation:**

- The sports village will be developed in Bhagalpur district, specifically in the Goradih block, to promote sports infrastructure and athlete training.
- The project has been approved with the allocation of government land to the Sports Department.

Q 113. Ans. C**Explanation:**

- Bihar secured investment proposals worth around ₹9,000 crore (over \$1 billion) through collaboration with the Asian Development Bank.
- This investment aims to boost infrastructure development, economic growth, and regional connectivity in the state.

Q 114. Ans. B**Explanation:**

- Dr. Mahendra Jha was awarded the Sahitya Akademi Award 2025 for his Maithili work "Dhatri Paat San Gaam."
- His contribution reflects the richness of Maithili literature and regional linguistic heritage.
- Sahitya Akademi awards are given in 24 languages every year.

Q 115. Ans. C**Explanation:**

- The Bihar Government has launched 34 Mobile Forensic Vehicles to strengthen on-site and fast-track crime investigation across the state. These vehicles are equipped with modern forensic tools to collect and analyse evidence directly from crime scenes, reducing dependence on central laboratories.
- The massive push for these vans is directly tied to the implementation of the new Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita (BNSS). Under the BNSS, it is now a strict legal mandate that a forensic expert must visit the crime scene for any offense punishable by seven years or more of imprisonment.

Q 116. Ans. C**Explanation:**

- On January 16, 2026, the Chandragupt Institute of Management Patna (CIMP) hosted Avinya Bihar 2.0 to commemorate National Startup Day. Organized by the Department of Industries in association with IIT Patna.
- IIT Patna was recognized as the best Incubation Center in the state, with CIMP Patna securing the second position. Among educational institutions, Government Engineering College (GEC) Vaishali was ranked first for its Startup Cell.

Q 117. Ans. B**Explanation:**

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The Indian Institute of Technology Patna has commissioned PARAM Rudra, Bihar's first supercomputer, marking a transformative development in the state's research and technology infrastructure.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** Established under the National Supercomputing Mission through a Memorandum of Understanding signed between IIT Patna and the Centre for Development of Advanced Computing. Under the National Supercomputing Mission, 37 supercomputers have been deployed nationwide with a combined capacity of 39 petaFLOPS, currently supporting over 12,000 researchers.

Q 118. Ans. A**Explanation:**

- Shri Gopal Ji Trivedi was awarded the Padma Shri for his notable contributions in the field of science and engineering, particularly in agricultural extension, technological adoption, and sustainable farming practices in Bihar.
- He was a former vice-chancellor of Rajendra Prasad Central Agricultural University, Pusa, is recognised for his work in agricultural extension, technological adoption and sustainable farming practices. A litchi farmer himself, he was the first to adopt rejuvenation canopy management in orchards.
- Shri Bharat Singh Bharti, associated with the field of art in Bihar, was honoured with the Padma Shri award for his lifelong contribution to Bhojpuri folk music.
- Shri Bishwa Bandhu (Posthumous), associated with the field of art in Bihar, was honoured with the Padma Shri award or his profound impact on Bihar's folk dance tradition.

Q 119. Ans. B**Explanation:**

- East Champaran's Keshar Raj has been selected for the Indian national team to participate in the Asian Cadet and Junior Fencing Championship 2026, which will be held in Jakarta, Indonesia.

Q 120. Ans. C**Explanation:**

- The Bihar government directed State government officials to meet people at their respective offices and addresses their concerns for two working days in a week (Mondays and Fridays). It aimed at tackling public grievances that persist due to the absence of government officials in the offices.

Q 121. Ans. B**Explanation:**

- India's Tallest Ardhanarishwar Statue India's tallest

Ardhanarishwar statue, standing at 108 feet, is taking shape in Chandasi village, Patna. On one side of the main statue, a 40-foot-tall statue of Lord Kartikeya is being installed, and on the other, a statue of Lord Ganesha, representing the completeness of Shiva's family.

Q 122. Ans. B**Explanation:**

- Recently, Ritesh Kumar and Praveen Kumar were sworn in as judges of the Patna High Court.
- The oath of office was administered to them at the court's centenary hall by Chief Justice Sangam Kumar Sahoo.
- Under Article 219 of the Constitution, the oath to High Court judges is administered by the Governor of the state or a person appointed by him, which is frequently delegated to the Chief Justice

Q 123. Ans. C**Explanation:**

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Peasants demanded an end to the tinkathia system, under which they were forced to grow indigo on a fixed portion of their best land at very low, unfair prices.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** Cultivators demanded that planters cancel the high-interest cash advances (dadani) and stop trapping them in permanent debt. They rejected the unjust loans and interest-burden that planters used to control them.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** Peasants wanted protection from physical violence, arbitrary fines and evictions, and demanded that colonial authorities set up a fair inquiry. Their pressure led to the Indigo Commission (1860), which officially recognised planter exploitation and recommended reforms.

Q 124. Ans. B**Explanation:**

- Lloyd : Major General (top command)
- Bird : Brigadier
- Sherwill : Captain (field officer)
- Pontet : Civil admin (Superintendent)

Q 125. Ans. C**Explanation:**

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Champaran agrarian struggle was the first popular movement that Mahatma Gandhi led after he returned from South Africa. The system locally called tinkathia forced the cultivators to grow indigo on 3/20th part of their holdings. Local leaders like Rajendra Prasad, A.N. Sinha, Braj Kishore Prasad, J.B. Kripalani and Rajkumar Shukla were already leading the agitation against the planters.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** Sir Edward Gait accepted the condition as just and proper and announced the inquiry.

Frank Sly was appointed Chairman of the Champaran Agrarian Committee (1917). The committee examined evidence and recommended abolition of the Tinkathia system.

Q 126. Ans. D

Explanation:

- **Assertion is incorrect:** The Nonia Rebellion (1770-1800 AD) was a grassroots economic uprising in regions like Hajipur, Tirhut, Saran, and Purnia against the British East India Company's monopoly and exploitation of the traditional salt and saltpetre makers.
- **Reason is correct:** Decades later, during the 1930 Salt Satyagraha, freedom fighter Buddh Nona responded to Gandhi's call by making salt. He was deceitfully arrested and thrown into a boiling salt cauldron, attaining martyrdom while bravely chanting 'Bharat Mata Ki Jai' and 'Vande Mataram'."

Q 127. Ans. C

Explanation:

- The Bharat Ratna, India's highest civilian award, has been conferred upon four eminent personalities native to Bihar.
 - ✓ Dr. Rajendra Prasad (Awarded in 1962)
 - Birthplace: Ziradei, Siwan district.
 - Key Fact: India's first President and the only individual to serve two full terms in the office. He was a pivotal leader of the Indian Independence Movement and President of the Constituent Assembly.
 - ✓ Jayaprakash Narayan (Awarded in 1999 - Posthumous)
 - Birthplace: Sitab Diara, Saran district.
 - Key Fact: Affectionately known as "Lok Nayak" (People's Hero). He is best remembered for leading the "Total Revolution" (Sampoorna Kranti) movement against the Emergency in the 1970s and for his crucial role in the 1942 Quit India Movement.
 - Ramon Magsaysay Award for Public Service (1965)
 - ✓ Ustad Bismillah Khan (Awarded in 2001)
 - Birthplace: Dumraon, Buxar district.
 - Key Fact: A legendary musician who elevated the Shehnai from a folk and ceremonial instrument to the global concert stage. He holds the historic distinction of playing the Shehnai at the Red Fort on the eve of India's independence in 1947.
 - Padma Vibhushan (1980)
 - Padma Bhushan (1968)
 - Padma Shri (1961)
 - ✓ Karpoori Thakur (Awarded in 2024 - Posthumous)
 - Birthplace: Pitaunjhia (now renamed Karpoori Gram), Samastipur district.

- Key Fact: Known as "Jananayak" (People's Leader), he served twice as the Chief Minister of Bihar. He was a monumental figure in championing social justice, famous for introducing the "Karpoori Formula" (1978), which pioneered reservations for backward classes in the state.

Q 128. Ans. B

Explanation:

- Babu Jagjivan Ram had organized a number of Ravidas Sammelans and had celebrated Guru Ravidas Jayanti in different areas of Calcutta (Kolkata). In 1934, he founded the Akhil Bharatiya Ravidas Mahasabha in Calcutta and the All India Depressed Classes League.
- Babu Jagjivan Ram played a very active and crucial role in the freedom struggle. Inspired by Gandhiji, Babuji courted arrest on 10 December, 1940. After his release, he entrenched himself deeply into the Civil Disobedience Movement and Satyagraha. Babuji was arrested again on 19 August, 1942, for his active participation in the Quit India Movement launched by the Indian National Congress.

Q 129. Ans. A

Explanation:

- The Bihar Provincial Congress Committee was formed in 1908 in Patna (with its first session/headquarters). It was established to facilitate Congress activities in the region, with its first president being Ali Imam, Hassan Imam.

Q 130. Ans. D

Explanation:

The seven students were **Martyrs at the Patna Secretariat:**

- Umakant Prasad Sinha (Raman Ji) – Ram Mohan Roy Seminary, Narendrapur, Saran
- Ramanand Singh – Ram Mohan Roy Seminary, Sahadat Nagar, Patna
- Satish Prasad Jha – Patna Collegiate School, Khadahara, Bhagalpur
- Jagatpati Kumar – Bihar National College, Second year, Kharati, Aurangabad
- Devipada Choudhry – Miller High English School, Silhat, Jamalpur
- Rajendra Singh – Patna High English School, Banwari Chak, Saran
- Ramgovind Singh – Punpun High English School, Dasharatha, Patna

Q 131. Ans. C

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The Cheros emerged in the Bihar-Jharkhand region after the decline of the Pala Empire (12th-13th century) and later settled in Palamau.

- **Statement 2 is correct:** In 1770–71, a succession dispute between Chitrajit Rai and Gopal Rai led to British intervention under Captain Camac, who captured the Palamu forts by March 1771. Chitrajit Rai and his Dewan Jainath Singh refused to hand over the forts and resisted the British militarily during this succession conflict.

Q 132. Ans. A

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The Ashokan pillar at Lauriya was erected in 249 BC and is located in Lauriya village under Areraj subdivision in Bihar.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** The Lauriya Areraj pillar no longer has its capital, which was originally an animal statue now kept in the Kolkata Museum, while the Lauriya Nandangarh pillar still has its lion capital.
- Additional information:
 - ✓ 36.5 ft high polished sandstone pillar (around 40 tons).
 - ✓ Tapering: 41.8 in (base) → 37.6 in (top).
 - ✓ Known as “Stambh Dharma Lekh”.
 - ✓ Bears 6 edicts in two parts (18 and 23 lines).

Q 133. Ans. C

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** A large hoard of Kushana coins found at Buxar includes coins from Vima Kadphises II to Vasudeva, indicating the presence and circulation of Kushana currency in the region.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** Excavations at Kumhrar (Patna) have yielded terracotta remains in Mathura red sandstone with characteristic Kushana features and dress, suggesting cultural influence of the Kushanas in Bihar, though not necessarily direct political control.

Q 134. Ans. D

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The remains of Vikramshila University include a massive square monastery of about 330 metres on each side with 208 cells, representing highly planned monastic architecture of the Pala period.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** A cruciform stupa is situated at the centre, forming the architectural and spiritual nucleus of the complex, around which the monastery is organized.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** The complex includes a library building with a unique water-based cooling system, where water from an adjoining reservoir was circulated through vents, showing advanced environmental engineering techniques.

Q 135. Ans. A

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** ‘Kirtilata’ and ‘Kirtipataka’ are written in Abahatta, representing transitional Indo-Aryan linguistic form.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** ‘Padavali’ is composed in Maithili, not Sanskrit.

Q 136. Ans. C

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** Sewak Ram, a former court artist of the Benares Maharaja, migrated to Patna in 1790 and worked there till 1826. He was known for his Kajli Seahi miniature technique and for depicting festivals like Dussehra, Chhath, and Holi.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** Shiva Dayal Lal (1820 – 1880) also painted miniature portraits on ivory and had a large clientele. Like Shiva Lal, he also painted scenes from daily life. This master artist was retained in the Durbar of Rai Sultan Bahadur, a Rais of Patna City.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** Bani Lai (1850 – 1901) was a pupil of Shiva Lal was known for his distinct, naturalistic style without exaggeration and for producing three types of works for different markets. His skill is evident in the second, depicting midday-rest in which the composition and drawing is excellent and the colours subdued.
- **Statement 4 is correct:** Hulas Lal (1785-1875) was known for producing portraits in a European style and belonged to a family of painters associated with Benares. Hulas Lal came from Benares and was a cousin of Jairam Das, the painter assistant of Sir Charles D’Oyly. In 1815, there were no European portrait painters working in Delhi. Lalji and his son Hulas had a reputation for producing portraits in a European manner. In a diary entry, James Fraser writes about the father-son duo.
- Other prominent artists of Patna Kalam:
 - ✓ Shiva Lal
 - ✓ Gopal Lal
 - ✓ Gur Sahay Lal
 - ✓ Bahadur Lal I
 - ✓ Bahadur Lal II
 - ✓ Jamuna Prasad
 - ✓ Kanhai Lal
 - ✓ Jaigovind Lal
 - ✓ Ishwari Prasad

Q 137. Ans. B

Explanation:

- Anugrah Narayan Sinha (18 June 1887 – 5 July 1957), known as Bihar Vibhuti, was an Indian nationalist politician, participant in Champaran Satyagraha, Gandhian, and one of the architects of modern Bihar. He served as the first Deputy Chief Minister and the Finance Minister of the Indian state of Bihar from 1946 to 1957.
- He was also a member of the Constituent Assembly of India, which was elected to write the Constitution of India and served in its first Parliament as an independent nation.
- When the first Congress ministry was sworn in on July 20, 1937, under the Government of India Act 1935, Dr. Sinha was assigned exactly three portfolios: Finance, Local Self-Government, and Public Works. The Council of Ministers was structured as follows:

1. **Shri Srikrishna Sinha (Premier)** – Home, Revenue, Jails, Judiciary, and Legislature.
 - ✓ Parliamentary Secretaries:
 - Shivanandan Prasad Mandal – Judiciary and Jails
 - Krishna Ballabh Sahay – Revenue, Appointments, and Political Affairs
2. **Shri Anugrah Narayan Sinha** – Finance, Local Self-Government, Public Works, and Commerce.
 - ✓ Parliamentary Secretaries:
 - Jagat Narayan Lal – Finance and Commerce
 - Jimut Bahan Sen – Public Works and Irrigation
 - Binodanand Jha – Local Self-Government, Medical, and Public Health
3. **Dr. Syed Mahmud** – Education and Development.
 - ✓ Parliamentary Secretaries:
 - Sarangdhar Singh – Education and Registration
 - Jagjivan Ram – Development
4. **Shri Jaglal Chaudhary** – Excise and Public Health.
 - ✓ Parliamentary Secretary:
 - Sayeedul Hoque – Excise

Q 138. Ans. B

Explanation:

The Indian National Congress was founded by Allan Octavian Hume on 28th December 1885 at Gokuldas Tejpal Sanskrit College in Bombay.

- The first session of the Indian National Congress in Bihar was held in 1912 at Bankipore (present-day Patna).
- The session was presided over by R.N. Mudholkar. Prominent Bihar leaders played crucial roles in organizing it: Mazhar-ul-Haq was the Chairman of the Reception Committee, and Sachchidananda Sinha served as the General Secretary.
- Before independence, undivided Bihar hosted a total of three INC sessions: Bankipore (1912), Gaya (1922), and Ramgarh (1940, now in Jharkhand).
- It was also the 27th session of INC.

Q 139. Ans. D

Explanation:

Prince of Wales' visit → 1921

- Indian National Army → 1945
- All-India Muslim League Session → 1938
- Champaran Satyagraha Meetings → 1917
- Gandhi Maidan was officially known as the "Patna Lawns". It was renamed to Gandhi Maidan in 1948 following the assassination of Mahatma Gandhi as a tribute to his deep connection with the grounds since 1917.

Q 140. Ans. A

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Sher Shah Suri (Farid Khan), born around 1486, initially served under the Nuhani

rulers in Bihar and established his influence in the court of Jalal Khan, despite opposition from rival Afghan chiefs supported by Bengal.

- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** In 1534, Sher Shah defeated the Bengal army at the Battle of Surajgarh, which marked a decisive step in establishing his supremacy in eastern India. The Battle of Surajgarh took place between Sher Shah Suri and the combined forces of the Lohani chiefs of Bihar and Sultan Mahmud Shah of Bengal.

✓ Between 1536–1537, he invaded Bengal and occupied its western territories, with full control achieved in 1538. This further consolidating his authority and expanding his territorial control, which later enabled him to challenge the Mughals and defeat Humayun at the Battle of Chausa (1539).

Major events:

- Battle of Ghaghra — 1529
- Acquisition of Chunar — 1530
- Siege of Chunar — 1532
- Battle of Surajgarh — 1534
- Siege of Gauda — 1538
- Battle of Chausa — 1539
- Battle of Kannauj (Bilgram) — 1540
- Conquest of Malwa — 1542
- Siege of Raisen — 1542–1543
- Battle of Sammel — 1544
- Siege of Kalinjar — 1545

Q 141. Ans. B

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** After Akbar's campaigns against the Afghan rulers of Bihar (1574–76) and the defeat of Daud Khan Karrani, Bihar was incorporated into the Mughal Empire and was organised as a Subah around 1580; however, the early Mughal phase continued to face repeated Afghan rebellions.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** Raja Man Singh I (1587–1594) consolidated Mughal authority by defeating powerful local chiefs of Gidhaur, Kharagpur, and Bhojpur, rather than forming alliances with them, thereby strengthening imperial control in the region.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** Man Singh established Rohtas as his capital, and later shifted the administrative centre to Rajmahal (renamed Akbarnagar), not to Munger, as part of Mughal consolidation in eastern India.

Q 142. Ans. C

Explanation:

- Patna College was established in 1863 in the building of an old Dutch factory.
- This reflects the transition from colonial trade infrastructure to modern education in Bihar.

Q 143. Ans. D**Explanation:**

- Jagdamba Devi – Pioneer Madhubani artist; National Award (1970); first Padma Shri in field (1975).
- Sita Devi – Jitwarpur; Bharni style; National Award (1975); Padma Shri (1981).
- Ganga Devi – Mithila; Kachni style; National Award (1976); Padma Shri (1984).
- Godawari Dutta – National Award (1980); Shilp Guru (2006); Padma Shri (2019).
- Mahasundari Devi – Madhubani; National Award (1982); Padma Shri (2011).
- Baua Devi – Jitwarpur; natural colors; National Award (1984); Padma Shri (2017).
- Bharti Dayal – Darbhanga; acrylic on canvas; National Merit (2005); National Award (2006).

Q 144. Ans. A**Explanation:**

- The recently held Bihar Legislative Assembly elections concluded with highest ever voter turnout of 66.91% . This is the highest voter turnout recorded in the State since 1951. Turnout among male voters was 62.8% and amongst female voters it was 71.6%.

Q 145. Ans. C**Explanation:**

- The Jal Mandir (Water Temple) at Pawapuri is a revered Jain shrine dedicated to Lord Mahavira, where he attained Nirvana in 528 BC and was cremated.
- The temple is constructed within a tank filled with lotus flowers, and this water body is maintained by rainwater and groundwater accumulation, giving the site its characteristic setting.

Q 146. Ans. D**Explanation:**

- According to the official data from the India State Forest Report 2023, the Valmiki Tiger Reserve (VTR) Valmikinagar division holds the record for the highest absolute area under forest cover in the state, measuring approximately 425 sq km.
- Highest total forest area: VTR Valmikinagar ranks first in Bihar for total geographical forest spread (425.04 sq km).
- Highest forest cover by percentage: VTR Ramnagar has the highest forest cover relative to its size, with 85.52% of its digitised boundary area classified as forest.
- Very Dense Forest (VDF): VDF in Bihar is primarily concentrated in the north-western region. VTR Valmikinagar holds the maximum VDF footprint in the state (182.86 sq km), whereas divisions in the Gangetic plains, such as Tirhut and Vaishali, record no Very Dense Forest.

Q 147. Ans. C**Explanation:**

- As per the Basic Animal Husbandry Statistics, 2025

released by Ministry of Fisheries, Animal Husbandry & Dairying, Bihar recorded the highest growth rate of egg production during 2024–25 at 9.99%, followed by Gujarat (8.57%) and Punjab (7.57%).

Q 148. Ans. C**Explanation:**

- In the Fiscal Health Index 2026 released by NITI Aayog, Bihar recorded a score of 30.9. This score reflects the state's current macroeconomic indicators and deficit management, upgrading its classification from the "Aspirational" tier to the "Performer" tier.

Q 149. Ans. A**Explanation:**

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Under the Jananayak Karpoori Thakur Samman Nidhi, the Bihar government will provide an additional ₹3,000 annually to eligible farmers.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** The total ₹9,000 is a combined amount from two different governments. It consists of ₹6,000 funded by the Central Government (under the PM-Kisan scheme in three instalments) and the additional ₹3,000 funded by the State Government.
- State Contribution: ₹3,000 annually (Jananayak Karpoori Thakur Samman Nidhi).
- Central Contribution: ₹6,000 annually (PM-Kisan scheme).
- Total Annual Assistance: ₹9,000 per farmer.
- Objective: To provide additional economic support and prosperity to the farmers of Bihar.

Q 150. Ans. B**Explanation:**

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Bihar's GSDP for 2024-25 grew by 13.1% at current prices, reaching ₹9,91,997 crore, which surpassed India's national average GDP growth.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** The share of the primary sector (agriculture and allied activities) actually dropped from 21.9% to 18.3%. It was the secondary sector (manufacturing, construction) whose share rose significantly from 21.1% to 26.8% in 2024-25.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** As of March 31, 2025, the state's total outstanding debt is ₹3,74,134 crore, which translates to a Debt-to-GSDP ratio of exactly 37.7%.
- **Statement 4 is correct:** The per capita power consumption in Bihar rose significantly to 374 kWh in 2024-25.
- **Other Key Facts:**
 - ✓ Real Growth: At constant prices, Bihar's GSDP grew by 8.6% in 2024-25.
 - ✓ Per Capita Income: Reached ₹76,490 at current prices in 2024-25, with Patna recording the highest district-level income at ₹2,41,220.
 - ✓ Capital Expenditure: The share of capital expenditure (asset creation) rose from 15.8% in 2020-21 to 22.3% in 2024-25.
 - ✓ Power Sector Losses: Aggregate Technical & Commercial (AT&C) losses reduced sharply to 15.54% in 2024-25.

73rd BPSC Foundation Batch

Prelims + Mains + Interview

BATCH 9

हिंदी माध्यम

📍 Musallahpur

ONLINE & OFFLINE

STARTS FROM 9th APRIL 2026

📍 Boring Road

ONLINE & OFFLINE

STARTS FROM 21st APRIL 2026

BATCH 6

Bilingual

BATCH 1

English Medium

📍 Boring Road

ONLINE & OFFLINE

STARTS FROM 21st APRIL 2026



Patna

Musallahpur

KGS Campus,
Near Sai Mandir,
Musallahpur Hat,
Patna, Bihar-800006

Boring Road

2nd Floor, Kumar
Tower, Boring Road
Chauraha, Patna,
Bihar-800001

Naya Tola

KP Yadav
Compound Kazipur,
Naya Tola, Patna,
Bihar-800004